There is no doubt that the device can handle demanding tasks, including heavy gaming, but it does get warm when pushed for long. In our CPU throttling test, the device retained 62 per cent of the performance. This means that short gaming sessions or regular heavy use will not be a major issue. If you plan to push the phone for long, the heat and performance drop become more noticeable.

But, as always, benchmark numbers do not tell the entire story. In everyday use, the Galaxy Z Flip 8 feels fast and responsive, thanks to One UI 9 and Samsung's optimisation. Whether I was switching between multiple apps, scrolling through social media, browsing the web or multitasking, the phone handled everything without any noticeable hiccups. Apps opened quickly, animations were smooth, and I rarely found myself waiting for the phone to catch up.





And the good part? The device gets 7 years of Android and security updates.

CAMERA

The camera setup on the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 8 remains unchanged from its predecessor. You get a 50-megapixel primary camera and a 12-megapixel ultrawide sensor at the back, while selfies are handled by a 10-megapixel front-facing camera. So, while the hardware is familiar, the real question is whether the cameras can still hold their own in the premium segment.

In daylight, the primary camera produces images that are pleasing to look at. Colours have a natural tone, and the overall processing does not go overboard with saturation. There is also enough sharpness and detail in the shots for everyday photography. However, if you ask me, I have seen better camera phones in this price segment, if you are not only looking at clamshell foldables.

The camera performs well in low-light situations. It manages exposure well and does not make night scenes look unnaturally bright. However, as the light drops, you may notice some noise and finer details become softer.

While this is not the norm in this segment, I really missed having a telephoto camera. The phone instead relies on digital zoom for closer shots. The results are usable at lower zoom levels in good lighting. However, if you zoom in further, details start to look softer. But anyway, the portrait mode does a good job. Subject separation is good, and the camera manages to keep the focus on the subject without making the background blur look too artificial. Edge detection is also fairly accurate, although it can struggle with finer details such as hair.

For selfies, the Galaxy Z Flip 8 has a 10-megapixel front-facing camera built into the inner display. It is decent for quick selfies and video calls. However, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 8 offers a useful trick. You can use the primary rear camera to capture selfies by using the cover screen. This gives you much better image quality than the inner front camera. It takes a little practice to get comfortable looking at the small cover display while framing yourself. But once you get used to it, it is a feature you are likely to use often.

VERDICT

If you ask me, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 8 feels like a refinement. It gets the basics right, with a compact and lightweight design, a sharp and vibrant display, decent everyday performance and battery life that can comfortably last a full day with moderate use.

At Rs 1,44,999, there are some compromises. The camera hardware remains unchanged, and while the cameras are good, I expected little more. The 25W charging is slow, and the phone gets warm during heavy work.

That said, the Z Flip 8 is not a phone you buy purely for specs. You buy it for the experience of having a full-sized smartphone that folds into a compact device. If portability, design and the foldable experience are your priorities, the Galaxy Z Flip 8 is definitely among the best options available in the market. But if you want the best cameras, faster charging, or strong performance, you can obviously choose a conventional form factor.

– Ayushi Jain

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 | RAM: 12 GB | Storage: 256/512 GB | Display(Cover): 4.1-inch Super AMOLED | Display(Inside): 6.9-inch Foldable Dynamic LTPO AMOLED 2x | Brightness: 3000 nits | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Camera (main): 50 + 12 MP | Camera (selfie): 10 MP | OS: Android 17 | Battery: 4300 mAh | Charging: 25W Wired, 15W Wireless

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